

CERVICAL RADICULOPATHY

TIPS & STRETCHES TO HELP YOU FEEL BETTER



Cervical radiculopathy occurs when a nerve in your neck is irritated or compressed, causing pain, tingling, numbness, or weakness that may travel into your shoulder, arm, or hand. Use these tips and stretches to support your recovery.



KEEP MOVING

Stay active and avoid long periods of sitting.
Take short walks and change positions throughout the day.



STRETCH DAILY

Gentle stretching can reduce tension and improve mobility.
Do the stretches below 1–2 times per day.



USE HEAT OR ICE

Try ice for the first 24–48 hours, then switch to heat.
Use for 15–20 minutes at a time.



MIND YOUR POSTURE

Sit and stand tall with shoulders relaxed.
Keep your neck in a neutral position and avoid prolonged looking down.



SUPPORT YOUR NECK

Use a supportive pillow that keeps your neck in a neutral position.



AVOID AGGRAVATING ACTIVITIES

Avoid heavy lifting, repetitive overhead motions, and activities that worsen your symptoms.



BE PATIENT & CONSISTENT

Nerve healing takes time. Small, consistent steps can make a big difference.

WHEN TO SEEK CARE

Seek medical attention if you experience:

- Worsening numbness, tingling, or weakness
- Loss of strength in your arm or hand
- Loss of coordination
- Severe pain that does not improve
- New or worsening symptoms

GENTLE STRETCHES FOR CERVICAL RADICULOPATHY

1 MEDIAN NERVE GLIDE



This helps improve nerve mobility and reduce symptoms in your arm and hand.

- Stand or sit tall.
- Start with your arm at your side, palm facing backward.
- Gently straighten your elbow, extend your wrist, and open your hand while tilting your head away from your arm.
- Hold for 2–3 seconds.
- Relax and return to start.
- Repeat 8–10 times.

2 CHIN TUCKS



This helps improve neck posture and reduce strain.

- Sit or stand tall, eyes forward.
- Gently pull your chin straight back, creating a “double chin.”
- Keep your head level—do not tilt up or down.
- Hold for 5 seconds.
- Relax and repeat.
- Repeat 10 times.

3 SIDE NECK BENDS



This stretch helps reduce tightness in the side of your neck.

- Sit or stand tall.
- Gently tilt your head toward one shoulder, keeping your opposite shoulder down.
- Hold for 20–30 seconds.
- Repeat on the other side.
- Repeat 2–3 times each side.

4 SHOULDER ROLLS



This helps reduce tension in your neck and shoulders.

- Sit or stand tall with arms at your sides.
- Roll your shoulders up toward your ears, then back, down, and forward in a smooth circle.
- Repeat 8–10 times.
- Then reverse direction and repeat 8–10 times.



Listen to your body. These stretches should not cause sharp pain.
Stop if you feel increased pain, numbness, or weakness and consult a healthcare provider.

IF YOUR SYMPTOMS PERSIST OR WORSEN, PLEASE FOLLOW UP WITH YOUR PROVIDER.

This handout is for educational purposes only and is not a substitute for professional medical advice.
Always consult your healthcare provider with any questions or concerns.